

THE TORI CONNECTION

*How a Miscarriage on a 24-Hour Shift Exposes the Complete
Causal Topology of Institutional Capture at Southwest Transplant Alliance*

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“What should have happened, now that I recognize, I should have gone to the FMLA, I should have immediately gone into counseling, but because of her response, I didn’t do any of that. She played me. She took advantage of it. She knew that I was not in the mental state to make those type of decisions.”

— Tori, recorded conversation, 2025

I. THE CHAIN

A woman named Tori worked as an Organ Recovery Coordinator at Southwest Transplant Alliance in Dallas, Texas, pulling 24-hour shifts that routinely extended to 32 and 36 hours under a shift architecture managed by her direct supervisor, a woman named Jocelyn, and during one of these travel shift months—in which every on-call day was a mandatory 24-hour shift with no sleep provision—Tori, at approximately ten weeks pregnant, suffered a miscarriage that she attributes to the physical toll of those shifts, and when she called Jocelyn as the first person she told at work, Jocelyn’s response was “the mission never stops, take a couple of days off, but remember, we need you for bootcamp,” which guilt-tripped Tori out of exercising her federally protected FMLA leave and out of seeking counseling, a suppression of grief that subsequently contributed to the collapse of her engagement with her fiancé Casey—and this is the same Jocelyn who was simultaneously sleeping with both Marcolin Eakins, STA’s IT Director (her organizational peer under CFO Stephanie Bowman), and Fibbens, STA’s General Counsel, thereby sexually compromising the two institutional gatekeepers most capable of investigating misconduct; the same Jocelyn who premeditated the theft of organizational documents to a California OPO, using her associate Keisha—a hire of Debra Polk, drinking buddy of both Jocelyn and Debra—to conduct technical reconnaissance on whether IT could recover her chat history post-departure; the same Jocelyn whose theft was covered up by Marcolin (who controlled the IT infrastructure but could not investigate without exposing the affair, his World Emerge Group LLC in Houston, and his chronic absence) and by Fibbens (who held legal oversight authority but could not exercise it because he was sexually compromised by the subject); and Keisha, who assisted the premeditated theft, later stole more than \$12,000 in laptops on her own way out; and Debra Polk, a Service Desk Supervisor with no reporting authority over engineers or systems administrators, systematically fired anyone whose competence threatened to expose Marcolin as a technical fraud—Fifi, John Nguyen, the rotating security engineers, Rob, Michael Golden (walked out of the building in a wheelchair, sobbing, in front of his wife and children), and finally me, Bo Chen,

terminated on my father's 69th birthday at 9 PM with no HR process, no termination letter, and no final pay—all to protect Marcolin from competence exposure during the TOSA merger lateralization that would have slotted him under CIO Steve Shelby and parallel to Ken Walker, my high school classmate from R.L. Turner in Carrollton and my college classmate from UNT in Denton; and when Tori, trapped in clinical burnout after the FMLA suppression, twice attempted to escape—first through a simulation position that Christina Solomon had set up for her, which died when Solomon was fired after an incident involving Maitlin Rigsby (now Harvey), a 23-year-old family friend of CEO Brad Adams whom Brad had installed in a fabricated epidemiologist role (nepotism), and the education department was absorbed by Heather Cloward, STA's HR Director, who wanted education for herself; and second through a Business Analyst position with Jonathan Hewlett, STA's Innovation Director, the same man Tori had confided in about the miscarriage and the FMLA suppression, who wanted to hire her, who agreed on compensation, and whose offer was killed when Heather's HR department capped the salary below what both the hiring manager and the candidate had accepted—three independent actors with three independent self-interested motives produced, without conspiracy, the complete foreclosure of one woman's attempt to survive an organization that had already taken her pregnancy, her fiancé, and her trust, and every internal reporting channel—the ethics hotline (an Exchange mailbox accessible to Marcolin, its most frequent subject), the General Counsel (sexually compromised and running a private suppression agreement with me), HR (personally implicated in career-blocking), the CFO (whose own assistant Kim Segura knew about the theft and either told Stephanie or didn't, neither being exculpatory), and the CEO (who received my March 18 disclosure letter and chose silence)—routed through a compromised gatekeeper, which is why I went external: eight public comments on CMS docket CMS-3409-P, an OIG complaint, a CMS complaint, distribution to thirty colleagues and TOSA leadership, upload to the Internet Archive, and the document you are reading now.

That is the skeleton. What follows is the body.

II. THE SHIFT

The Organ Recovery Coordinator's travel shift month works like this: every day you are on call, you are on for twenty-four hours. There is no sleeping provision. There is no handoff to a relief team at hour twelve. If a hospital calls at hour twenty-two to say a ventilated patient's neurological function has collapsed and the family is ready to discuss donation, you drive to the hospital, you sit with the family in the worst hours of their lives, you manage the donor's clinical stability, you coordinate the recovery, you arrange the transport, and somewhere around hour thirty-two or thirty-six, you drive home. Then you wait for the next call. Seventeen people die every day in the United States waiting for a transplant. The person answering that call at 3 AM is the reason the number is not higher.

Tori was working these shifts when she discovered she was pregnant. She was approximately ten weeks along. She and her fiancé Casey had picked a provider,

scheduled the first sonogram, and planned a trip to North Carolina to tell his grandmother—a woman named Nana who had always taken care of Tori, whose own childhood had been shaped by abuse in daycare, fear of the dark, the death of her grandfather the day before her birthday, and a resilience forged in circumstances no child should have to survive. Nana once quietly paid eight thousand dollars to fix Tori's HVAC system without being asked. That is who they were going to tell first. Nana, then Tori's parents. Then the future.

During the travel shift month, Tori started getting dizzy. She nearly fainted in a grocery store. She was not a person who fainted. Casey knew that. The day before they were supposed to fly to North Carolina, Tori stood up from the couch and felt pain so severe that even Casey—who understood her pain tolerance, who knew she did not react to things lightly—saw it in her face and understood that something had gone catastrophically wrong.

She miscarried at approximately ten weeks. She did not go to the emergency room. She sat in the bathroom for thirty minutes, processing what had happened, while Casey knocked on the door. She did not know her body would continue to process the pregnancy hormonally—the bloating, the nausea, the volatility persisting for weeks while her endocrine system ran a program for a pregnancy that no longer existed. She was not prepared for any of it. Nobody had told her. She was trying to survive.

The next morning, she flew to North Carolina. She bled for days in silence, masked the agony as menstrual cramps, and protected Nana from the knowledge that the grandchild she was about to learn about had already been lost. Only Casey knew. Only Casey, and later Samra, and later me, and later Jonathan Hewlett. Her parents do not know to this day.

III. THE MISSION NEVER STOPS

When Tori returned to Texas and called Jocelyn—her direct supervisor, the first person she told at work—Jocelyn's response was:

“The mission never stops. Take a couple of days off, but remember, we need you for bootcamp.”

Six words—*the mission never stops*—spoken to a woman whose body was still metabolizing a dead pregnancy. Spoken by the supervisor who controlled the shift schedule that had run that body through twenty-four and thirty-six-hour cycles during the ten most physically vulnerable weeks of her life. Spoken with the emotional precision of someone who understood exactly how to weaponize Tori's dedication against her—because Jocelyn knew that Tori cared about the staff, cared about the patients, cared about the families sitting in hospital waiting rooms at 3 AM deciding whether to donate their loved one's organs, and would interpret a request to return as a moral obligation rather than what it actually was: a managerial convenience dressed in the language of purpose.

Tori did not take FMLA. She did not seek counseling. She did not tell her family. She went back to the 3 AM calls, the grieving families, the donors whose organs might save someone else while her own body was still hormonally processing the child she would not have. In her own words, recorded under Texas one-party consent:

“She played me. She took advantage of it. She knew that I was not in the mental state to make those type of decisions.”

The engagement with Casey did not survive. The miscarriage was the wound. The suppressed grief—the FMLA not taken, the counseling not sought, the space to be human not given—was the infection. The relationship that should have been the container for healing became the container for everything neither of them had been allowed to process. When I asked Tori directly whether having the child would have changed the outcome with Casey, she said: “Probably.” One word. One cosmic ray flipping a bit in the register of a life.

Tori lost a pregnancy. She lost the man she was going to marry. She lost the family they were building. And the supervisor who said the mission never stops was, at that exact moment, doing things that make those six words the most obscene sentence ever spoken inside that building.

IV. WHAT JOCELYN WAS ACTUALLY DOING

Jocelyn was sleeping with Marcolin Eakins, STA’s IT Director. They were organizational peers—both reported to CFO Stephanie Bowman. The relationship was lateral, which made the compromise mutual and the leverage symmetric: if either spoke, both burned. Marcolin controlled the IT infrastructure where every digital record in the organization resided. He could not investigate anything Jocelyn did, because investigating Jocelyn meant Jocelyn could expose the affair, which would unravel his World Emerge Group LLC—a competing IT consulting firm in Houston, publicly registered with the Texas Secretary of State—and his chronic absence from the Dallas headquarters 250 miles away.

Jocelyn was simultaneously sleeping with Fibbens, STA’s General Counsel and Chief Legal Officer. One person sexually compromised both the custodian of the organization’s digital infrastructure and the custodian of its legal obligations. The IT Director who should have investigated the document theft could not, because the thief was his lover. The General Counsel who should have provided legal oversight of the investigation could not, because the thief was also his lover. The visible tension between Marcolin and Fibbens—the awkwardness that everyone in the office could feel but nobody could explain, the “brotherly hugs” that I observed with disbelief after Tori explained what was behind them—was two men who had been sharing the same woman, who knew it, who could do nothing about it because acknowledging the situation would detonate them both.

How do we know this? Because Tori was Jocelyn's direct report. Tori observed the relationships firsthand. Tori confirmed both on a recording in a one-party-consent state. The woman whose testimony establishes the sexual compromise of both the IT Director and the General Counsel is the same woman whose supervisor guilt-tripped her out of FMLA after her miscarriage. Tori's evidentiary knowledge and Tori's personal injury are inseparable. She did not observe the nexus from outside. She lived inside it.

The Premeditated Theft

Months before her departure to a California OPO in July–August 2025, Jocelyn told her associate Keisha that she was planning to leave. Keisha—hired by Debra Polk, drinking buddies with both Jocelyn and Debra—then approached me with a technical question: after someone leaves the organization, would it be possible for IT to look up their past chat history and communications? I told her yes, depending on retention policies. I did not understand at the time that this was operational security. Jocelyn, through Keisha, was assessing whether her digital trail would be recoverable after her departure. She was conducting reconnaissance for a planned exfiltration while still drawing a paycheck from a 98% CMS-funded nonprofit—and while still telling a grieving subordinate that the mission never stops.

After Jocelyn departed with documents, Kim Segura—CFO Stephanie Bowman's own executive assistant—walked into the IT department repeatedly, shaking her head, telling us that what Jocelyn did on her way out “wasn't kosher.” The CFO's assistant knew. Whether Stephanie herself knew is a question that answers itself: either Kim told Stephanie, meaning Stephanie knew and did nothing, or Kim did not tell Stephanie, meaning the CFO's own assistant independently chose not to escalate document theft to her own boss. There is no third option. Neither is exculpatory.

Jocelyn was also terrified that her Teams messages would be exposed after her departure. The irony is perfect: the woman who had Keisha ask me whether IT could recover chat history was afraid of the answer. Jocelyn had written things about people in those messages—things that, if surfaced, would have made her departure look less like a career move and more like an escape under fire. The pre-departure reconnaissance was not idle curiosity. It was operational security for someone who understood that the digital record of her conduct was a ticking liability, and who needed to know whether the organization she was robbing had the forensic capability to prove it.

The Cover-Up

The investigation that should have followed Jocelyn's departure never happened. Marcolin controlled the infrastructure where the evidence lived and could not touch it without detonating himself. Fibbens held the legal authority to investigate and could not exercise it without exposing that he had slept with the subject. They did not cover up through active conspiracy. They covered up through institutional paralysis—the quiet, bureaucratic decision to simply not look, because looking would have required seeing themselves.

The supervisor who told a grieving, miscarrying subordinate that the mission never stops was simultaneously compromising two members of the executive leadership team through sexual relationships, conducting pre-departure reconnaissance for document theft, and relying on her drinking buddies—Keisha and Debra—to provide logistical and political support. *The mission never stops* was not a leadership philosophy. It was resource extraction from a woman in crisis by a supervisor whose actual mission was self-enrichment, self-protection, and exit planning. Tori's pregnancy was collateral damage. Her body, her grief, her relationship, and her federally protected leave were the price of Jocelyn's staffing coverage during the planning phase of a premeditated theft.

V. THE DRINKING BUDDIES AND THEIR DEPARTURES

Jocelyn, Keisha, and Debra Polk formed a social unit—drinking buddies, by multiple accounts, socializing constantly. This is not office gossip. It is the organizational topology through which the dysfunction propagated.

Keisha was hired by Debra. Keisha assisted directly in Jocelyn's pre-departure reconnaissance. Then, on her own departure from STA, Keisha stole two company laptops worth more than twelve thousand dollars. One hire by Debra. Two separate thefts by two separate individuals in the same social circle: the first intellectual property to a competitor, the second physical assets to a personal residence. Debra also hired John Owens, who became so violently threatening in the workplace that Rob—a weightlifter, a physically large and confident man—told me he had been genuinely scared. This is the caliber of personnel that Debra selected and cultivated: a theft accomplice, a thief, and a man whose behavior made a weightlifter afraid.

Jocelyn also survived three separate corporate compliance investigations during her tenure at STA—a fact I am not aware of any other employee matching. She played the race card strategically to deflect criticism: when Tori, in a one-on-one meeting, told Jocelyn that she found her intimidating, Jocelyn pivoted instantly to racial framing—“one thing you don't say to a Black woman is that they're intimidating”—turning a direct report's honest feedback about management style into a racial grievance that silenced the conversation. Every supervisor placed above Jocelyn was subsequently pushed out: Roger, then Kirsten Gappleberg, then the vacuum that Heather filled. Jocelyn maintained a relationship with Brad and Stephanie that insulated her from consequences that would have ended anyone else's tenure multiple times over.

VI. THE SERVICE DESK SUPERVISOR WHO RAN THE DEPARTMENT

When I started at STA in March 2024, Chad was the VP of IT—the buffer between Marcolin and CFO Stephanie Bowman. Approximately one month into my tenure, Chad was let go. That removal is the structural precondition for everything that follows. Without the VP buffer, Marcolin reported directly to Stephanie—a CFO who, by multiple

accounts, did not know how to turn on her computer. Marcolin's need for a loyal proxy intensified.

He hired Debra Polk. His explanation to me: "She reminds me of my mother who passed away." His mother's name was also Deborah. A Medicare-funded nonprofit responsible for saving lives through organ transplantation hired a Service Desk Supervisor because the IT Director—who was collecting a full-time salary while operating a competing business from another city—found sentimental comfort in her resemblance to his dead mother.

Debra's first week, she asked me to get a screwdriver and walk with her to Chad's office to take his large monitors. She wanted the office, too—a director-level space, for a supervisor. She wanted Marcolin to make C-suite so she could inherit the director's title. The monitors were the first move in a long game of accumulating symbols of authority she had not earned and could not justify with performance, because her work product was net negative: it would have been cheaper for the organization to pay her salary and have her do absolutely nothing, because the work she produced required correction by the people around her. Debra then hired Brandon, who reminded her of a younger version of Marcolin. Brandon wanted to bring a clone of himself. Each layer of the hierarchy reproduced its own emotional reflection, recursively, until the IT department was staffed not by meritocratic assessment but by a cascading series of psychological projections dressed in job titles.

She understood the dependency with crystalline clarity. If Marcolin was exposed as absent, non-technical, and running a competing business on the side, she would fall with him. He was her meal ticket. Every termination she orchestrated was in service of protecting that meal ticket.

VII. THE KILL LIST

Before Debra, Marcolin did his own killing. Michael J. Deininger built STA's IT department. Eleven years. United States Air Force — signals intelligence, top secret security clearance. The institutional knowledge of STA's entire IT infrastructure lived in Deininger's head because he had architected it from the ground up. Marcolin pushed him out, and then did what people do when they eliminate the person whose competence indicts them: he rewrote the narrative. Marcolin badmouthed Deininger relentlessly — to me, to others, to anyone who would listen — recasting the man who built the house as the man who broke it. After eleven years of service to a Medicare-funded organ procurement organization and a career of military-grade technical discipline, Deininger's only remaining recourse was a Trustpilot review and a LinkedIn post. Two public comments on commercial platforms, because every internal channel that should have protected an eleven-year veteran was already captured by the man who wanted him gone. That was Marcolin operating alone, before the proxy. Then he hired Debra, and the artisanal became industrial.

None of them reported to her. This is the fact that transforms a management problem into a governance scandal. Debra was a Service Desk Supervisor. The people she eliminated were security engineers, network engineers, and systems administrators—different roles, different classifications, different reporting chains. She had formal authority over none of them. She operated through Marcolin's delegated power and through the social dynamics of an office where proximity to the director's ear was the only currency that mattered more than competence.

Fifi (Oluwafisayo Ofeimu). Security contractor. Same orientation class as Debra—they arrived on the same day. Within months, Debra approached me to collaborate in badmouthing Fifi to Marcolin. It worked. Fifi was gone. I thought at the time: this is the first time I have ever seen a contractor get rid of another contractor.

John Nguyen. Security engineer. Did not report to Debra. Gone.

Four additional security engineers cycled through in approximately two years. Average tenure: six months. The revolving door turned, and the hand on it was Debra's.

Robert Flippo. He fought back. He wrote a three-page resignation letter to C-suite and HR documenting Marcolin's LLC, his absence, and Debra's de facto control of the department. The institutional response: Marcolin performed two weeks of attendance theater, then reverted to the Houston baseline. Rob was pushed out. Years later, after my own termination, Rob called me and said something I had not known: "Debra was trying to get rid of you for a year."

Jesse Cadena. Service desk technician. On his way out, Jesse scheduled an appointment with Kim Segura — Stephanie Bowman's executive assistant — to sit down with the CFO and tell her what was actually happening in the IT department under Marcolin. The meeting was on the calendar. Marcolin caught wind of it. Rather than let Jesse work out his two weeks, Marcolin cut him early — terminated before the appointment could take place, before Jesse could sit across from Stephanie and say aloud what Rob had put in writing and what everyone in the department already knew. The pattern is not subtle: every employee who attempted to route information to leadership through a channel Marcolin did not control was intercepted and removed before the signal could arrive.

Michael Golden. The network engineer. One of the most technically gifted people I have worked with in my career. A contractor promised a contract-to-hire conversion on April 16. He contributed. He solved problems. He made the department look competent—which was precisely the problem.

Marcolin did not want to push Golden out. That detail is critical. The IT Director whose incompetence the entire elimination campaign existed to conceal did not want to do this. Debra insisted. I heard the argument in the IT room: "You have to think about this strategically. If you don't do this, and then the integration happens, and Ken Walker happens, and Steve Shelby happens, everybody's gonna see." Everybody's gonna see that the IT Director does not know technology. That the Service Desk Supervisor has been running the department through political maneuvering. That the entire architecture is a performance.

Debra terminated Golden's accounts herself. A Service Desk Supervisor, disabling the credentials of a network engineer outside her reporting chain, while the IT Director was not in the building. She called Brittany in HR directly. When Eric asked whether Golden was fired, both Debra and Marcolin said no. He is not fired. He is not terminated. One month later, Michael Golden returned from back surgery. He arrived in a wheelchair with a mobility scooter. His wife was with him. His four children were with him. John Charles, our 23-year-old help desk technician, walked up and gave him a bear hug. Less than an hour later, Golden was walked out of the building. A grown man, sobbing in front of his family, because a Service Desk Supervisor had decided that his competence was a political threat to an IT Director who was running a competing business from Houston.

It gave me PTSD to watch it. I sat at my desk. I said nothing. What could I have said. The same system that destroyed him was already working on me.

VIII. THE LATERALIZATION AND THE DISTRIBUTION LIST

In March 2026, the proposed merger between STA and Texas Organ Sharing Alliance—TOSA, headquartered in San Antonio, roughly half STA's headcount—was restructuring the IT reporting chain in real time. Marcolin announced on a Teams call to the entire team that he now reported to Steve Shelby, TOSA's CIO. Ken Walker, TOSA's Director of IT, reported directly to Shelby. The integration was lateralizing Marcolin: slotting him beneath Shelby, parallel to Walker. The man who had been hiding in Houston was about to be supervised by someone who would notice.

Ken Walker and I went to R.L. Turner High School in Carrollton, Texas. Same graduating class. Same physics teacher. We attended the same university—UNT in Denton. We have known each other for over twenty years. When Marcolin and Debra discovered this connection, I became something more dangerous than a sysadmin: I became a conduit. A direct personal channel between STA's IT department and the TOSA leadership that was about to assume authority over it.

Ken sent me a Teams message: Steve Shelby had directed him to tell me to create a distribution list for the integration. Marcolin had told our team he reported to Shelby. Ken told me Marcolin was busy in a conference. I created the list. Thirty seconds of work.

The next morning, before I could set down my bag, Debra was waiting. She lectured me all morning—a Service Desk Supervisor, lecturing a Sysadmin III about a routine directory task performed at the direction of the incoming CIO's chain of command. Then she locked herself in Marcolin's office for thirty minutes. When Marcolin arrived around noon, he opened his door and said, "Bo, come here." With Debra still sitting in the room, loud enough for the entire department:

"Never again go around me like that. Do you understand? This is the last and final time I'm telling you this."

For a distribution list. A thirty-second task. He then imposed a punitive change-approval process that turned thirty seconds into weeks. He was not managing IT operations. He was fighting the integration itself, because the integration was the mechanism that would expose him. This was one week before Golden was eliminated. I was next.

IX. MARCH 18, 2026

It was my father's sixty-ninth birthday.

At three in the afternoon, Debra sent me home. She said I was not feeling well and told me to take my laptop. I did what she said. I went home planning to return Thursday morning. At nine o'clock that night, my Teams app locked. My accounts were disabled. No phone call. No termination letter. No final pay. No notification to HR. Heather Cloward, STA's HR Director, did not contact me for over a week. A Service Desk Supervisor and an IT Director had executed the termination of a Sysadmin III by disabling his accounts at nine o'clock on a Wednesday night—on his father's birthday—without generating a single piece of documentation, without processing final wages as required under the Texas Payday Law, and without telling the HR department that they had just separated an employee who had a private agreement with the General Counsel and eight public comments on a federal regulatory docket.

I wrote to Brad Adams, the CEO, that night. I told him about the gentleman's agreement with Fibbens. Brad never responded. They removed the only reason I was holding back.

X. THE DISMANTLING OF TORI'S CHAIN OF COMMAND

When Tori was promoted to Supervisor of Organ Recovery Coordinators in July 2025, her reporting chain was: Tori, reporting to Chelsea Flemming (Manager of Clinical Services), reporting to Samantha Collins (Manager), reporting to Amanda LeGrow (Director of Clinical Services), reporting to Doug Butler (COO). Four people stood between Tori and the CEO. Within seven months, every single one of them was gone.

Samantha Collins was abruptly fired without stated reason in September 2025. Amanda LeGrow was let go in late October or early November 2025. Doug Butler—the COO, the second-in-command of the entire organization—was terminated forty-eight hours before the January 22, 2026 GOLA Town Hall and never mentioned again. At that Town Hall, CFO Stephanie Bowman presented approximately \$69 million in cash as “250+ days of runway” without disclosing a \$25 million revenue bond, its debt-service coverage ratio covenant, or the springing lockbox mechanism that could seize incoming revenue if the covenant was breached. Six hundred staff from both STA and TOSA were told their jobs were safe and the merger was imminent. CMS had never approved the merger application. Six days later, CMS published the proposed rule containing the Separate

DSA Evaluation provision that would structurally eliminate the merger's regulatory rationale.

Chelsea Flemming—the last remaining link in Tori's original chain of command—was forced out through a devastating performance evaluation administered by an interim director who had held the position for only one month at the time of the evaluation. Chelsea had attempted to withdraw her resignation and was refused. She was actively seeking an employment attorney at the time of her departure.

Four supervisors. Four departures. September, November, January, early 2026. By the time my own accounts were disabled on March 18, Tori's entire reporting chain had been dismantled. The woman who had survived the miscarriage, the FMLA suppression, the collapse of her engagement, the two blocked career escapes, and eight years of institutional failure was now reporting into a vacuum—a chain of command that had been systematically emptied of every person who might have advocated for her, understood her history, or served as institutional memory of what had been done to her.

XI. THE CAREER ESCAPE KILLED TWICE

After the miscarriage, after the FMLA suppression, after the engagement collapsed, after watching her supervisor steal documents and walk away protected by the men she had compromised—Tori tried to escape. Not out of STA. Out of the clinical grind. Out of the 24-hour shifts and the 3 AM calls and the families deciding whether to donate their child's organs. She tried to move into a position where her intelligence and experience could serve the organization without destroying her body.

The Simulation Position

Christina Solomon set Tori up for a simulation coordinator position. It was essentially hers—one week from the interview. Then Christina was terminated. Tori told me what happened: during a demonstration, Christina walked in while Tori was showing something to Maitlin Rigsby (now Maitlin Harvey)—a 23-year-old family friend of CEO Brad Adams. Maitlin's parents went to school with Brad. When Maitlin lost her job in D.C. after COVID, Brad created an epidemiologist position for her at STA—a fabricated role at a 98% CMS-funded nonprofit for a personal connection's daughter. Christina made comments that upset Maitlin, reducing her to tears. Maitlin filed a complaint. Christina was fired.

With Christina gone, the simulation position had no champion. But Christina's departure created a vacuum that Heather Cloward moved to fill. Heather wanted the education department. Multiple employees confirmed this to me independently over the span of a year. Tori told me directly. An HR Director absorbing education is unusual at best, empire-building at worst. The simulation position evaporated—caught between the CEO's nepotism (Maitlin), a departmental power grab (Heather), and the chaos following Jocelyn's departure.

The Business Analyst Position

Tori interviewed for a Business Analyst position with Jonathan Hewlett, STA's Innovation Director. Hewlett is the man Tori had confided in about the miscarriage, the FMLA suppression, and the broken engagement. He knew what she had endured. He knew why she needed to leave the clinical role. He wanted to hire her. They agreed on compensation. The deal was done in everything but signature.

Then Heather's HR department capped the salary at a rate below what both the hiring manager and the candidate had already accepted. The deal died. Not because Tori was unqualified. Not because Hewlett didn't want her. Because the HR Director's department overrode the hiring manager's judgment on a compensation number that the two people who actually mattered had already settled.

The irony is architectural. The same HR Director who absorbed the education department and killed the simulation position then capped the salary and killed the BA position. The same department, the same HR Director, two independent actions, one cumulative victim. Three independent actors—Jocelyn (FMLA suppression trapping Tori in clinical burnout), Maitlin/Brad (nepotism triggering Solomon's departure), and Heather (education grab plus salary cap)—pursuing their own institutional self-interest produced, without conspiracy, the complete foreclosure of one woman's attempt to survive an organization that had already taken her pregnancy, her fiancé, and her trust.

XII. THE CHANNELS THAT COULD NOT WORK

Five people attempted to report through internal channels at STA over multiple years. All five failed through the same structural capture.

The ethics hotline operated through an Exchange mailbox that IT staff—including Marcolin, the most frequent subject of complaints—could access at any time. It was a honeypot, not a reporting channel. The General Counsel (Fibbens) was sexually compromised by the person whose theft he should have investigated, and entered a private bilateral suppression arrangement with me—a “gentleman's agreement” in which I would not file further CMS comments while employed, disclosed to no one on the board or in HR. The HR Director (Heather) personally blocked Tori's career advancement twice and was now implicated in the complaints she would be expected to investigate. The CFO (Stephanie) oversaw both Marcolin and Jocelyn as peers, and her own assistant Kim Segura visibly knew about Jocelyn's theft. The CEO (Brad) installed a family friend in a fabricated role, tolerated Marcolin despite years of documented complaints, received my March 18 disclosure letter, and chose silence. The Board received all information through Brad's curation filter.

Every internal accountability mechanism routed through a compromised gatekeeper. The architecture of the organization did not merely fail to detect dysfunction. It was structured—whether by design or by the accumulated self-interest of everyone who benefited from opacity—to guarantee that honest signals would be intercepted, filtered,

or suppressed before reaching anyone with both the authority and the independence to act.

That is why I went external. Eight public comments on CMS docket CMS-3409-P, totaling more than 150 pages. An OIG complaint. A CMS complaint. Distribution to approximately thirty colleagues and to TOSA leadership. Upload to the Internet Archive. The public site opnaorta.ai. And this document.

XIII. THE DISCRIMINATORY PATTERN

After Rob's departure, Debra's hiring pattern shifted. The change was visible to everyone in the department and spoken of by no one, because naming it would have required acknowledging a reality that the organizational culture had been conditioned to ignore. In my own words, from the recorded voicemail to Heather Cloward on March 31, 2026: "After the whole incident with Rob, Deborah never again hired anybody who was white or even Hispanic or Asian ever again."

I am Chinese American. I say this not to claim special victim status but because it is a verifiable fact that HR's own demographic hiring data either confirms or refutes. The IT department's demographic composition, when I was hired in March 2024, was more equitable. It shifted. The shift correlated with Debra's tenure. The pattern is the pattern regardless of who names it.

XIV. THE FULL CIRCLE

Follow the chain from any node. Every path leads through Tori.

Brad installs his family friend Maitlin Harvey at STA. Nepotism becomes the institutional baseline. Brad tolerates Marcolin's chronic absence, his Houston LLC, and the accumulating complaints through a strategic silence that protects Brad from the consequences of his own personnel tolerance. Stephanie Bowman, the CFO, oversees both Marcolin and Jocelyn as peers. Chad, the VP of IT, buffers Marcolin from scrutiny until Chad is let go in April 2024. Marcolin hires Debra. Marcolin sleeps with Jocelyn. Jocelyn sleeps with Fibbens. One person, two C-suite-adjacent positions sexually compromised.

Jocelyn manages the ORC shift architecture. Tori gets pregnant. Tori miscarries. Jocelyn says *the mission never stops*. Tori does not take FMLA. Tori does not seek counseling. Tori's engagement collapses. Tori confides in Hewlett—the Innovation Director who will try to rescue her career and be blocked by Heather.

Jocelyn premeditates theft. Keisha conducts the reconnaissance. Jocelyn departs with stolen documents. Kim Segura, Stephanie's own assistant, knows. Marcolin suppresses the investigation because investigating Jocelyn means exposing himself. Fibbens cannot

investigate because he slept with the subject. The cover-up is not a decision. It is a structural inevitability. Keisha, having helped plan Jocelyn's theft, steals twelve thousand dollars in laptops on her own way out. Debra's hire. Debra's social circle. Debra's personnel judgment.

Debra eliminates anyone threatening Marcolin's cover. Fifi. John Nguyen. The security engineers. Rob—who tried to report and was absorbed. Golden—who was too competent to survive, terminated against Marcolin's own reluctance, walked out in a wheelchair in front of his children. Then me—fired on my father's birthday because I created a distribution list at the direction of the incoming CIO's chain of command and because my friendship with Ken Walker threatened to bring the TOSA integration into direct contact with the truth.

Tori's entire chain of command is dismantled: Samantha Collins fired in September, Amanda LeGrow in November, Doug Butler forty-eight hours before the January Town Hall, Chelsea Flemming forced out by a one-month interim director's devastating evaluation. Four supervisors, four departures, seven months. The woman who survived all of it reports into a vacuum.

Heather's department grabs education when Solomon is terminated—a termination entangled with Maitlin's nepotism. The simulation position dies. Heather's department caps the salary on the BA role with Hewlett. The second escape dies. Tori is trapped by three people's self-interest: Jocelyn's FMLA suppression, Maitlin's nepotistic presence, and Heather's departmental ambition.

The ethics hotline runs through Marcolin's inbox. Fibbens enters a private suppression agreement and tells no one. Five people report through internal channels. All five fail. Every path through the building passes through a compromised gatekeeper. I go external. Eight comments on the CMS docket. OIG. CMS. Thirty colleagues. TOSA leadership. The Internet Archive.

XV. WHAT THE MISSION ACTUALLY REQUIRED

Jocelyn said the mission never stops. She was wrong.

The mission stopped for Jocelyn the moment she decided that stealing documents to a California OPO was more important than the subordinate she had just told to come back to work after losing a pregnancy. The mission stopped for Marcolin the moment he moved to Houston and started a competing LLC while collecting a director's salary from a Medicare-funded nonprofit. The mission stopped for Debra the moment she decided that protecting Marcolin's fraud was more important than the careers, the dignity, the medical leave, and the surgical recovery of the people working beneath her. The mission stopped for Fibbens the moment he slept with the person he was supposed to be able to investigate. The mission stopped for Brad the moment he received a letter naming every failure mode in the building and chose silence. The mission stopped for Heather the

moment her departmental ambition overrode the career trajectory of a woman who had already been through more than any employee should have to survive.

The mission never stopped for Tori. She kept answering the 3 AM calls. She kept sitting with families. She kept managing donors through twenty-four-hour shifts while her body was still processing the child she would not have. She kept doing the work that the mission actually requires—the physical, emotional, human labor of being present at the intersection of death and life, where a family’s worst moment becomes a stranger’s second chance.

That is the difference between the scaffolding and the core wire. The scaffolding talks about the mission. It puts the mission in PowerPoint decks and conference speeches and CEO compensation packages. It invokes the mission to suppress a woman’s FMLA rights and then uses the same mouth to plan a document theft to a competitor. The core wire does not talk about the mission. The core wire does the mission. At 3 AM. In a hospital. With a family that just lost everything.

Tori is the core wire. Everything above her was scaffolding.

And the man who saw it all, documented it all, recorded it all, filed it all on a federal docket, and called HR on the last day of the comment period—is a sysadmin who got fired on his father’s birthday for creating a distribution list.

This document is the record of what the scaffolding cost.

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